PREVENTION CHECKLIST

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Part – B

Following these actionable steps will help you protect your digital identity and hard-earned money while navigating your studies and social life.

'Stay Safe Online' Checklist for Students

- **[ ] Secure Your Digital Identity:** Use a dedicated Password Manager to create unique, complex passwords for your University portal, Gmail, and social media. Avoid using your birthdate or "123456."
- **[ ] Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA):** Activate 2FA on all major accounts. Even if someone steals your password, they won't be able to log in without the code sent to your authenticator app or phone.
- **[ ] UPI Safety—The "PIN for Paying" Rule:** Remember that you **never** need to enter your UPI PIN to *receive* money. If someone sends you a QR code and asks you to "scan and enter PIN" to get a scholarship or prize, it is a scam.
- **[ ] Verify UPI Payee Names:** Before hitting 'Pay' on apps like GPay or PhonePe, always double-check the verified name of the recipient. Scammers often use names similar to official organizations to trick students.
- **[ ] Beware of "Public" Wi-Fi:** Avoid accessing your bank accounts or student portals on free campus or café Wi-Fi. If you must use them, always use a reputable VPN to encrypt your data.
- **[ ] Audit App Permissions:** Periodically check which apps have access to your microphone, camera, and contacts. Delete "cracked" or "modded" APKs, as they often contain hidden spyware.
- **[ ] Fact-Check Before Clicking:** Treat "urgent" emails about exam results or internship offers with suspicion. Hover over links to see the real URL before clicking, and never download attachments from unknown senders.
- **[ ] Protect Your Webcam:** Use a physical webcam cover when not in online classes. Malware can sometimes give hackers remote access to your camera without the indicator light turning on.

How to Report Cyber Crimes in India

If you fall victim to an online scam or witness cyberbullying, do not hesitate to use the official government channels:

- **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal:** Visit [suspicious link removed] to file a complaint online.

- **National Helpline Number:** Call **1930** immediately for financial frauds to increase the chances of freezing the stolen funds in the scammer's account.